1964. The International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN) creates its Red List of Threatened Species. In the 1990s, Georgina Mace pioneers the scientific criteria of inclusion of species.

1977. Carl Woese establishes a new, third category of organisms – the prokaryotes.

1988. Edward O. Wilson coins the term biodiversity and later identifies the key human threats to biodiversity.

1988. Norman Myers's "biodiversity hotspots" concept identifies ten hotspots where conservation efforts should preserve rare species.

2014. The Red List of Ecosystems is officially recognised by the IUCN.

2024. The IUCN Red List shows that more than 46,000 species, more than 30 per cent of extant species assessed – are at risk of extinction.

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